Active Maintenance Report: coppock_2025

Coppock (2025, Political Science Quarterly): The Effects of Party Cues Are Not the Effects of Partisanship

2026-11-05

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1 Summary

This repository recomputes Figure 1 and checks the prose of a four-page review article, which reanalyzes five survey experiments from *The Power of Partisanship* (Dyck and Pearson-Merkowitz 2023). The review deposited no code and no data. Its data are the book's, from the UNC Dataverse collection, and are released under CC0.

- **Panels (a), (c), and (e) reproduce.** 108 of 108 plotted values agree within 0.0005. The largest gaps are 0.0001 on estimates and 0.0002 on interval ends. **The specifications behind that agreement were inferred from the plotted positions**, so it shows that this rewrite finds what was plotted. It is not an independent check that the specifications are the right ones. The panels use three different weight and party codings, which the article does not state.
- **Panel (b) does not reproduce, and p. 3 contradicts itself.** See Errata.
- **Panel (d) is not compared.** See Figure verification.
- **The deposit's Stata files were not run**, because Stata is not available here. `value_script` and `match` are NA throughout, so this repo has no archive-versus-page comparison.

Link	
Article	10.1093/psquar/qqaf037
Data collection	UNC Dataverse, datasets listed in `original_manifest.csv`
Errata	`coppock_2025_errata.pdf`

To reproduce, run `Rscript run_all.R`. It fetches the 11 deposited files, verifies them against `original_manifest.csv` on MD5 and byte size, recomputes the figure, builds the ground truth, and runs the gate. The figure positions come from `ground_truth/extract_figure_1.py`, which needs the article PDF as an argument. The PDF is not redistributed here.

```
download_original.R, original_manifest.csv   the deposited surveys, not redistributed
maintained/                                  the recomputation and in_text_claims.R
ground_truth/                                the extraction, positions, ground truth, and ga
errata.qmd, coppock_2025_errata.pdf          corrections to the article
```

2 Paper overview

The review argues that the book's experiments estimate the effects of party cues and of chamber control, which do not manipulate the book's main causal variable. Study 1 and Study 2 use the 2018 survey, Study 3 the 2017 survey, Study 4 the 2020 survey, and Study 5 the 2019 survey.

The 2018 survey holds free-text responses in `Q149`, one of which includes a respondent's email address. Nothing in this repo reads or redistributes that column, and the file comes from the public deposit rather than from this repo.

3 Original archive reproducibility

The review itself has nothing to run. The book's Stata files are in `original/` once fetched and were not executed. All 11 files match the manifest. The maintained code is a rewrite in R from the deposited `.dta` files, not a port of the `.do` files.

4 Errata

`coppock_2025_errata.pdf` carries two entries, defined in `errata.qmd` and written to `errata_entries.csv`.

1. **Study 2, in note form.** The first two Study 2 sentences and the third cannot both hold. Figure 1(b) supports the third, while the survey supports the first two (Democrats 0.212 weighted and 0.067 unweighted, Republicans -0.049 and -0.045). Swapped labels would explain the mark labeled Republican and leave the mark labeled Democrat unexplained. The original figure script was not found, so the cause is open and the entry corrects nothing.
2. **A dropped verb in Study 3.** "whether they given no cue" should read "whether they are given no cue".

5 The extraction and the two instruments

`ground_truth/published_claims.csv` holds 139 rows: 114 plotted values, 11 descriptive claims, and 14 structural, definitional, or transcribed tokens. The article prints no estimate as a number. Its figure is vector, so `extract_figure_1.py` converts each mark through its panel's axis ticks. The positions take nothing from the data.

`ground_truth/build_ground_truth.R` joins those positions to the recomputation, and computes each descriptive claim across cells. `maintained/in_text_claims.R` selects the same quantities cell by cell. `ground_truth/claims_gate.R` runs the second as a program, requires one printed line per declared claim in both directions, requires the two instruments to agree at the printed precision, and requires every claim id in the errata spine to name an extraction row.

Both instruments read the same output files, so their agreement is evidence about the selection and arithmetic. It says nothing about whether the inferred specification is the one the review used.

6 Coverage

Claim type	Verdict	Rows
definitional	no verdict	2
descriptive	does not hold	1
descriptive	holds	8
descriptive	no verdict	2
pipeline	does not match	6
pipeline	matches	108
structural	no verdict	5
transcribed	no verdict	7

The nine descriptive verdicts are about direction. Study 2's first two sentences hold in sign while every interval covers zero. In Study 1, all four two-thirds signs hold, while the interval for Republicans under the Republican cue covers zero, which sits uneasily with "clear evidence".

Some claims have no verdict. The abstract's summary states no scope, so the share of panel (a) and (e) cells with its signs (0.80) carries no verdict. The sentence saying the reanalyses arrive at the authors' estimates is not tested, because this repo holds no copy of the book's printed estimates. The book's page and year are unchecked for the same reason. Footnote 3's citation was checked against Crossref on 2026-11-05.

7 Number-by-number comparison

Panel	Values	Within 0.0005	Largest estimate gap	Largest interval gap
a	48	48	0.0001	0.0002
b	6	0	0.2575	0.2948
c	48	48	0.0001	0.0002
e	12	12	0.0000	0.0002

The tolerance is set once in `build_ground_truth.R` and is half of the third decimal. It is wider than the largest gap in the panels that reproduce, and no precision of the marks was measured independently. Panel (b)'s row compares with the unweighted difference in means, which is the specification of panels (a) and (c). `maintained/output/figure_1b_specifications.csv` also reports the weighted one.

8 Maintained rewrite

`maintained/figure_1_panels.R` computes each panel with `lm_robust` as a difference in means between cue and no cue within party. The specifications are as follows.

Panel	Study	Survey	Weights	Party
a	1	2018	none	pid7, 1 to 3 and 5 to 7
b	2	2018	not settled	not settled
c	3	2017	none	pid7, 1 to 3 and 5 to 7
d	4	2020	none	pid7, slopes and cue means only
e	5	2019	survey	pid3, 1 and 2

The script asserts the survey's 40 percent labels and the direction of the candidate scale at the point of use.

9 Figure verification

The figure is not redrawn. Its check is the comparison above, which uses the positions of the published marks.

Panel (d) is not read from the PDF. The marks are points, lines, and ribbons across cue, cost, and party, so reading them would mean inferring a further specification for a comparison the review's sentences do not need. Those two sentences state direction only, and the recomputed cost slopes and cue means test them. A plotting error in panel (d) would not be caught here.

10 R environment

Package	Version
R	4.6.1
tidyverse	2.0.0
estimatr	2.0.1.9000
haven	2.5.5